# End-of-Support Management Module (ESMM)

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OOF® Origin Open Foundation®

Independent Methodological Authority

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## Canonical Definition

End-of-Support Management Module (ESMM) is the Core Module within Software Retirement Standard (SRTS) that governs how changes to the availability, scope, responsibility, and termination of software support and maintenance are identified, evaluated, communicated, controlled, and preserved throughout the software retirement lifecycle.

## ESMM establishes end-of-support as an identifiable governance condition

affecting the relationship between a software object, its support provider, supported capabilities, maintenance obligations, security update availability, operational users, dependent systems, and continuing responsibilities.

## The module distinguishes support termination from maintenance termination,

support availability from support effectiveness, vendor support status from actual operational use, and the end of a support obligation from the elimination of operational risk.

## It requires support transitions to remain connected to identifiable

software versions, support arrangements, applicable time or event conditions, affected stakeholders, available assistance, known limitations, continued operational dependencies, and required retirement or replacement pathways.

ESMM recognizes that software may remain in production after formal support ends, that different support capabilities may terminate at different times, and that third-party, internal, community, or extended support may provide different levels of continuing assistance.

It also recognizes that unsupported software may remain subject to operational, security, contractual, evidentiary, and continuity obligations even when ordinary maintenance is no longer available.

## ESMM governs the classification and controlled treatment of these

conditions without treating the cessation of support as proof that software has been retired.

## It applies to enterprise applications, commercial software, open-source

components, cloud services, operating systems, firmware, AI systems, autonomous software agents, and embedded or industrial software.

Its principal governance output is the Software End-of-Support Profile.

## Operational Role

## ESMM establishes the governance framework for software support transitions

and the continuing conditions that arise when support is reduced, modified, transferred, or terminated.

It governs:

• Support object identification

• Support provider identification

• Support arrangement recognition

• Support scope definition

• Support capability classification

• Support lifecycle conditions

• End-of-support recognition

• End-of-maintenance recognition

• Support status verification

• Support transition planning

• Support termination conditions

• Support responsibility

• Support authority boundaries

• Support communication

• Support dependency assessment

• Continued unsupported operation

• Security update availability

• Critical correction availability

• Extended support

• Alternative support

• Support transfer

• Operational restrictions

• Unsupported software risk

• Support evidence

• Support status monitoring

• Support exceptions

• Support reassessment

• Support closure

• Handoff to retirement governance

ESMM does not independently withdraw software from operation or establish that software retirement has been completed.

## Operational Question

How can software support and maintenance transitions remain identifiable, evidence-supported, and governable when support capabilities, providers, contractual conditions, security update availability, operational dependencies, and continuing responsibilities may change or terminate while the software itself remains in use?

## Position in Architecture Governance Flow

## SLGA™ Governance Flow

## Software Requirements → Software Creation → Software Dependencies →

Software Configuration → Software Quality → Software Security → Software Release → Software Deployment → Software Change Management → Software Retirement

## Cross-cutting: Software Lifecycle Control

## SRTS Core Module Flow

## Retirement Planning Module (RPM) → End-of-Support Management Module (ESMM)

→ Software Migration Module (SMM) → Residual Dependency Management Module (RDMM) → Retirement Closure Control Module (RCCLM)

ESMM is the second Core Module within SRTS.

## It governs the support conditions identified during retirement planning and

establishes their implications for continued operation, migration, dependency management, and retirement closure.

Its governance remains applicable when software support ends before retirement planning begins or when support continues after operational withdrawal.

• Governed Space

## Software End-of-Support Governance

## This governed space concerns the identification, modification, reduction,

transfer, and termination of software support and maintenance capabilities.

It begins when a software support condition becomes relevant to an identifiable software object.

## It includes support scope, provider responsibility, service availability,

maintenance capability, security updates, transition conditions, affected stakeholders, operational restrictions, and continuing obligations.

It remains active where software continues operating after support ends or where support-related responsibilities remain unresolved.

It concludes for a defined support relationship only when the applicable support transition has been established and remaining obligations have been appropriately resolved, transferred, or preserved under governance.

## Governed Object

The primary Governed Object is:

## A Software Support Transition Case representing the evidence-supported

relationship between an identifiable software object, its applicable support arrangement, support provider, support capabilities, changing support conditions, affected operational dependencies, transition requirements, continuing responsibilities, and resulting support status.

The governed object must preserve, where applicable:

## Support Transition Case ID

## Software Object ID

## Software Version

## Support Provider

## Support Arrangement Reference

## Current Support Status

## Support Scope

## Maintenance Status

## Security Update Status

## Support Transition Origin

## Support Change Condition

## Effective Support Transition Time

## Affected Users and Systems

## Continuing Operational Use

## Operational Restrictions

## Residual Support Obligations

## Responsible Function

## Support Evidence

## Support Status Version

## Scope

ESMM governs:

## Software Support Identification

## Support Provider Identification

## Support Arrangement Classification

## Support Capability Assessment

## Support Lifecycle Recognition

## End-of-Support Recognition

## End-of-Maintenance Recognition

## Security Update Availability

## Support Transition Conditions

## Support Responsibility Transfer

## Extended Support

## Alternative Support

## Unsupported Software Operation

## Support-Related Risk Identification

## Operational Restriction Requirements

## Stakeholder Communication

## Support Evidence Preservation

## Support Status Verification

## Support Exception Management

## Support Reassessment

## Support Transition Closure

The module does not create contractual obligations or determine legal liability.

## It preserves the governance relationships necessary to identify and

evaluate such obligations through applicable specialized mechanisms.

## Foundational Principle

## The termination of software support changes the conditions under which

software can be maintained, corrected, secured, and relied upon; it does not automatically terminate the software's operational presence or the responsibilities associated with its continued use.

Support status must be established according to the actual capabilities and obligations available for the identified software object.

Support Terminated ≠ Software Withdrawn.

Support Available ≠ Support Sufficient.

Vendor Support Ended ≠ All Support Capability Eliminated.

## Support Transition Case Identity

Every governed support transition must have a stable identity.

Relevant elements include:

## Support Transition Case ID

## Software Object Reference

## Support Provider Reference

## Support Arrangement Reference

## Transition Origin

## Transition Status

## Effective Condition

## Responsible Function

## Evidence Reference

## Record Version

The identity must remain stable across support announcements, reassessments, transfers, and closure.

## Supported Software Identification

ESMM must identify the software object to which the support condition applies.

Relevant elements include:

## Product Name

## Software Object ID

Version

## Build

## Edition

## Deployment Model

## Supported Platform

## Environment

## Support Contract Reference

## Applicable Support Channel

A general product-level announcement must not automatically be applied to every version or deployment without establishing its actual scope.

## Support Provider Identification

ESMM must identify the provider or function responsible for the relevant support capability.

Potential providers include:

## Original Software Vendor

## Internal Engineering Team

## Third-Party Support Provider

## Open-Source Maintainer

## Community Support Network

## Infrastructure Provider

## Managed Service Provider

## Extended Support Provider

## Successor Organization

Provider identity must remain distinguishable from software ownership and operational responsibility.

## Support Arrangement

## A support arrangement establishes the applicable relationship under which

assistance or maintenance is provided.

Relevant elements include:

## Support Provider

## Supported Software

## Supported Versions

## Covered Capabilities

## Support Conditions

## Support Period

## Service Restrictions

## Response Commitments

## Exclusions

## Termination Conditions

## Applicable Evidence

ESMM must not infer contractual support obligations solely from the existence of technical assistance.

## Support Capability Classification

Support may include different capabilities.

Relevant categories include:

## Technical Assistance

## Defect Investigation

## Corrective Maintenance

## Security Updates

## Compatibility Updates

## Performance Corrections

## Configuration Assistance

## Incident Response

## Recovery Assistance

## Documentation

## Operational Guidance

## Migration Assistance

Support status must reflect which capabilities remain available rather than relying only on a binary supported/unsupported label.

## Support Scope

ESMM must establish the scope of the applicable support relationship.

Relevant dimensions include:

## Software Product

Version

## Edition

## Platform

## Deployment Environment

## Supported Configuration

## Support Capability

## Customer or User Group

## Geographic or Contractual Scope

## Time Period

A support capability available for one software configuration must not automatically be assumed applicable to another.

## Support Lifecycle Conditions

Software support may pass through multiple identifiable conditions.

Potential conditions include:

## Full Support

## Standard Maintenance

## Limited Support

## Security-Only Support

## Extended Support

## Third-Party Support

## Community Support

## Support Transition Pending

## End of Maintenance

## End of Support

## Unsupported Operation

These conditions must remain associated with their actual capabilities and restrictions.

## End-of-Support Recognition

ESMM must identify the condition under which a support arrangement ends.

Potential triggers include:

## Scheduled Support Expiration

## Contract Termination

## Vendor Announcement

## Product Discontinuation

## Version Obsolescence

## Provider Withdrawal

## Service Termination

## Support Eligibility Change

## External Requirement

## Loss of Required Support Capability

Recognition must distinguish announced future termination from support that has already ended.

## End-of-Support Effective Condition

The effective end-of-support condition must be established through applicable evidence.

Relevant elements include:

Effective Date

## Effective Event

## Affected Software

## Affected Versions

## Affected Support Capabilities

## Provider Reference

## Applicable Exceptions

## Transition Arrangements

## Evidence Source

A scheduled end date must not be confused with a verified current support status.

## End-of-Maintenance Recognition

ESMM must separately identify maintenance termination.

Relevant elements include:

## Maintenance Provider

## Maintenance Scope

## Corrective Update Availability

## Compatibility Maintenance

## Security Maintenance

## Maintenance End Condition

## Remaining Support Capabilities

## Continuing Operational Use

End of maintenance may occur before, after, or simultaneously with other support changes.

## Support and Maintenance Distinction

ESMM must preserve the difference between support and maintenance.

Support may involve assistance, diagnosis, guidance, recovery, and communication.

Maintenance may involve software modification, correction, updating, and continued technical adaptation.

A software product may retain technical assistance while no longer receiving ordinary maintenance updates.

Conversely, a software component may continue receiving community maintenance without a formal support service.

Support Capability ≠ Maintenance Capability.

## Security Update Availability

ESMM must identify the availability of security-related corrections.

Relevant elements include:

## Security Update Provider

## Supported Versions

## Update Eligibility

## Known Vulnerability Coverage

## Update Distribution Channel

## Update Frequency or Conditions

## Security-Only Support

## Update Termination Condition

## Known Limitations

Security update availability must not be inferred solely from a general support label.

## Critical Correction Availability

Some support arrangements may preserve limited critical corrections after ordinary maintenance ends.

Relevant elements include:

## Critical Defect Criteria

## Eligible Software Versions

## Correction Provider

## Applicable Conditions

## Correction Availability

## Approval Requirements

## Delivery Restrictions

## Evidence

Critical correction availability must remain distinct from comprehensive maintenance support.

## Support Status Verification

ESMM must establish the actual support condition through appropriate evidence.

Potential evidence includes:

## Vendor Lifecycle Notices

## Support Contracts

## Service Agreements

## Provider Statements

## Maintenance Records

## Update Availability Records

## Technical Support Records

## Published Lifecycle Documentation

## Internal Support Capability Assessments

Unverified support assumptions must remain classified as uncertain.

## Support Evidence Applicability

Support evidence must be evaluated against:

## Software Identity

Version

## Edition

## Platform

## Deployment Environment

## Provider

## Support Arrangement

## Capability

## Effective Time

## Known Exceptions

Evidence that one version is supported does not establish support for every version.

## Support Transition Origin

A support transition may originate from:

## Vendor Lifecycle Policy

## Contract Expiration

### Maintenance Termination

### Provider Insolvency or Withdrawal

### Technology Obsolescence

### Security Capability Loss

### Infrastructure Change

### Software Retirement Decision

### Organizational Restructuring

### External Requirement

The origin must remain traceable to the resulting support status.

## Support Transition Purpose

A support transition may serve different purposes.

Potential purposes include:

### Terminate Obsolete Support

### Move to Extended Support

### Transfer Support Responsibility

### Reduce Maintenance Scope

### Prepare Software Retirement

### Support Software Migration

### Maintain Restricted Legacy Operation

### Consolidate Support Providers

The purpose must remain distinguishable from the actual transition outcome.

## Support Transition Assessment

ESMM must evaluate the consequences of the proposed or occurring support change.

Relevant dimensions include:

### Operational Impact

## Security Impact

## Maintenance Impact

## Dependency Impact

## User Impact

## Recovery Impact

## Migration Impact

## Economic Impact

## Continuity Impact

## External Obligation Impact

Assessment must reflect the software's actual operational role.

## Continued Operational Use

ESMM must identify whether software remains operational after support changes.

Relevant elements include:

## Active Deployments

## Operational Functions

## Active Users

## Dependent Systems

## Scheduled Tasks

## External Interfaces

## Data Processing

## Recovery Dependencies

## Physical-System Functions

## Operational Owner

Continued operation must remain an explicit governance condition.

## Unsupported Software Operation

Unsupported operation exists when software remains operational without the applicable support capability required or previously available for its use.

ESMM must preserve:

## Software Identity

## Operational Environment

## Unavailable Support Capabilities

## Known Security Conditions

## Operational Dependencies

## Responsible Function

## Applicable Restrictions

## Retirement or Replacement Pathway

## Review Conditions

Unsupported operation must not be concealed behind an obsolete inventory status.

## Unsupported Operation Classification

Unsupported operation may be classified as:

## Unsupported — Operational

## Unsupported — Restricted Operation

## Unsupported — Migration Pending

## Unsupported — Retirement Pending

## Unsupported — Critical Dependency

## Unsupported — Isolated

## Unsupported — Under Exception

## Unsupported — Status Unverified

Each classification must remain evidence-supported and scope-specific.

## Support Dependency Assessment

ESMM must identify systems and processes affected by the support condition.

Relevant elements include:

## Dependent Applications

## Operational Processes

## External Customers

## Integration Partners

## Data Consumers

## Infrastructure Components

## Recovery Systems

## Embedded Devices

## Autonomous Systems

A support change may affect systems that do not directly interact with the support provider.

## Support Risk Recognition

ESMM must identify material risks associated with reduced or terminated support.

Potential risks include:

## Uncorrected Vulnerabilities

## Unresolved Defects

## Compatibility Degradation

## Unavailable Technical Expertise

## Recovery Limitations

## Operational Instability

## Dependency Failure

## Data Accessibility Risk

## Unsupported Infrastructure

## Physical-System Consequences

Risk identification must not be mistaken for formal risk acceptance.

## Security Exposure After Support Termination

ESMM must identify security exposure arising from support changes.

Relevant elements include:

## Known Vulnerabilities

## Missing Security Updates

## Unsupported Cryptographic Components

## Exposed Interfaces

## Unmaintained Dependencies

## Credential Risks

## Monitoring Limitations

## Compensating Controls

## Retirement Requirements

## Detailed vulnerability assessment and remediation remain governed by

applicable security mechanisms.

## Operational Restriction Requirements

Unsupported software may require operational restrictions.

Potential restrictions include:

## Network Isolation

## Restricted User Access

## Limited Functionality

## Read-Only Operation

## Reduced External Connectivity

## Enhanced Monitoring

## Controlled Execution Windows

## Restricted Data Processing

## Mandatory Review Conditions

Restrictions must be justified by the actual software conditions and applicable authority.

## Extended Support

Extended support may preserve selected capabilities beyond the ordinary support period.

Relevant elements include:

## Extended Support Provider

## Covered Software

## Covered Versions

## Available Capabilities

## Security Update Availability

## Service Conditions

## Effective Period

## Exclusions

## Termination Conditions

Extended support must not automatically be treated as equivalent to full support.

## Alternative Support

Alternative support may be provided by a different internal or external function.

Potential sources include:

## Internal Engineering Team

## Third-Party Maintenance Provider

## Community Maintainers

## Specialized Legacy Support Provider

## Successor Vendor

## Managed Service Provider

Alternative support must be evaluated for capability, scope, reliability, authority, and applicable obligations.

## Support Provider Transition

Where support responsibility changes, ESMM must preserve:

## Previous Provider

## Successor Provider

## Affected Software

## Transferred Capabilities

## Excluded Capabilities

## Transition Conditions

## Required Documentation

## Operational Contacts

## Evidence Transfer

## Effective Responsibility State

A change of provider does not automatically establish continuity of every support capability.

## Support Capability Continuity

ESMM must assess whether required support capabilities remain available during a provider or arrangement transition.

Relevant elements include:

## Technical Knowledge

## Source Code Access

## Build Capability

## Required Tools

## Security Update Capability

## Diagnostic Capability

## Recovery Knowledge

## Dependency Information

## Operational Documentation

## Responsible Personnel

Support continuity must be assessed against actual capabilities rather than provider identity alone.

## Support Responsibility

Every material support relationship must have an identifiable responsibility reference.

Relevant elements include:

## Support Provider

## Operational Owner

## Maintenance Responsible Function

## Security Responsible Function

## Incident Response Responsibility

## Migration Responsible Function

## Retirement Responsible Function

## Escalation Responsibility

Responsibility assignment must remain distinguishable from capability and authority.

## Support Authority Boundary

ESMM must identify applicable authority conditions.

Relevant elements include:

## Support Arrangement Authority

## Maintenance Authorization

## Security Update Authorization

## Operational Restriction Authority

## Support Transfer Authority

## Retirement Decision Authority

## External Approval Requirements

## Delegation Conditions

Authority to terminate support does not automatically establish authority to withdraw operational software.

## Stakeholder Identification

ESMM must identify stakeholders affected by support changes.

Potential stakeholders include:

## Software Owners

## Operational Teams

## Users

## Customers

## Support Providers

## Maintenance Providers

## Security Functions

## Integration Partners

## Data Owners

## Infrastructure Operators

Stakeholder identification must reflect material operational and contractual relationships.

## Support Transition Communication

ESMM must establish communication requirements where applicable.

Relevant elements include:

## Affected Software

## Support Change

## Effective Condition

## Unavailable Capabilities

## Continuing Capabilities

## Operational Restrictions

## Migration Requirements

## Required Stakeholder Actions

## Communication Responsibility

## Communication Evidence

A support announcement must not be treated as evidence that affected systems have completed their transition.

## Support Notice Traceability

Support notices must remain traceable to the applicable software and support relationship.

Relevant elements include:

## Notice ID

## Issuing Provider

## Software Identity

## Affected Versions

## Support Change

## Effective Time

## Recipients

## Required Actions

## Evidence Reference

## Notice Version

Material corrections or changes must preserve the relationship to earlier notices.

## Support Transition Timing

ESMM must identify material support transition timing.

Relevant elements include:

## Announcement Time

## Support Change Effective Time

## Maintenance End Time

## Security Update End Time

## Extended Support Period

## Migration Deadline

## Retirement Target

## Review Conditions

Different support capabilities may terminate at different times.

## Support Transition Readiness

ESMM must assess readiness for a material support change.

Relevant elements include:

## Affected Software Identified

## Support Scope Established

## Operational Use Identified

## Dependencies Assessed

## Security Implications Identified

## Affected Stakeholders Identified

## Communication Requirements Established

## Continuing Responsibilities Assigned

## Operational Restrictions Prepared

## Retirement or Migration Pathway Identified

Readiness must remain distinct from the support transition's actual effective state.

## Support Transition Preconditions

Material support transitions may require preconditions.

Potential preconditions include:

## Applicable Support Decision

## Required Notice

## Alternative Support Availability

## Operational Restriction Readiness

## Migration Preparation

## Security Review

## Continuity Arrangement

## Responsibility Transfer

## Evidence Preservation

## Competent Authority

## The applicability of each precondition depends on the support arrangement

and governed operational context.

## Support Transition Execution

ESMM governs the recognition and evidence of support changes taking effect.

Relevant elements include:

## Transition Event

## Affected Support Capabilities

## Effective Condition

## Provider Responsibility

## Operational Consequences

## Continuing Obligations

## Status Verification

## Transition Evidence

Support transition execution does not establish software withdrawal.

## Support Status Monitoring

ESMM must support monitoring where support conditions remain relevant to operational software.

Potential monitoring concerns include:

## Support Expiration

## Security Update Availability

## Extended Support Changes

## Provider Capability Changes

## Unsupported Deployments

## Operational Restrictions

## Migration Progress

## Retirement Progress

## Newly Discovered Dependencies

Monitoring must remain proportionate to the software's operational significance.

## Support Condition Change

Support conditions may change after an initial classification.

Potential changes include:

## Support Extension

## Early Support Termination

## New Security-Only Support

## Provider Replacement

## Support Scope Reduction

## Support Capability Restoration

## Contractual Modification

## New Eligibility Requirement

Material changes must trigger reassessment where earlier conclusions are affected.

## Support Reassessment

ESMM must support reassessment when:

## Support Evidence Changes

## Provider Capability Changes

## Software Version Changes

## Operational Use Changes

## Security Conditions Change

## Dependencies Change

Migration Is Delayed

Retirement Is Deferred

## Alternative Support Becomes Available

Reassessment must preserve the earlier support status and the evidence supporting its revision.

## Support Exception Governance

An exception may be necessary when ordinary support transition requirements cannot be satisfied.

Relevant elements include:

## Exception ID

## Affected Support Condition

## Reason

## Applicable Authority

## Alternative Control

## Operational Restriction

## Residual Risk

## Validity Condition

## Review Requirement

## Evidence

An exception must not create an unsupported assumption that software remains adequately supported.

## Emergency Support Conditions

Exceptional operational circumstances may require temporary support arrangements.

Potential conditions include:

## Critical Security Incident

## Operational Recovery

## Unexpected Provider Withdrawal

## Critical Software Failure

## Migration Failure

## Essential Service Continuity

Emergency support must remain subject to identifiable authority, scope, evidence, and subsequent review.

## Support Evidence Integrity

ESMM must preserve the integrity of material support evidence.

Relevant elements include:

## Evidence Source

## Software Identity

## Provider Identity

## Support Capability

## Effective Time

## Applicable Scope

## Known Limitations

## Verification Method

## Record Version

Unsupported or contradictory evidence must remain identifiable.

## Support Status Uncertainty

ESMM must explicitly represent uncertainty.

Potential conditions include:

## Unknown Support Provider

## Unverified Support Contract

## Unclear Version Eligibility

## Conflicting Vendor Notices

## Unknown Security Update Availability

## Unverified Extended Support

## Unclear Maintenance Capability

## Unknown Effective Date

Material uncertainty must not be converted into a definitive supported or unsupported classification without evidence.

## Support Status Classification

ESMM recognizes the following governance classifications:

## Full Support

## Standard Support

## Limited Support

## Security-Only Support

## Extended Support

## Alternative Support

## Community Support

## Support Transition Pending

## Support Scope Changing

## End of Maintenance

## End of Support

## Unsupported — Operational

## Unsupported — Restricted

## Unsupported — Migration Pending

## Unsupported — Retirement Pending

## Support Transferred

## Support Terminated

## Support Status Unverified

## Exception Active

## Reassessment Required

## Unknown

## Conflicted

Each classification must remain connected to its applicable software object, capability, provider, scope, and time.

## Support Transition Closure

A support transition may be closed when its applicable support change has been established and its continuing obligations have been appropriately addressed.

Closure must preserve:

## Support Transition Identity

## Previous Support Condition

## Resulting Support Condition

## Affected Software

## Effective Transition Evidence

## Communication Evidence

## Continuing Operational Use

## Residual Support Obligations

## Responsible Functions

## Closure Decision

Support transition closure must not be treated as retirement closure.

## Continuing Support Obligations

Some obligations may continue after ordinary support ends.

Potential obligations include:

## Contractual Assistance

## Security Notification

## Historical Documentation

## Data Access Support

## Migration Assistance

## Incident Cooperation

## Warranty-Related Obligations

## Regulatory Requirements

## Evidentiary Preservation

## ESMM identifies and preserves these relationships without independently

determining their legal enforceability.

## Support and Retirement Relationship

ESMM must preserve the relationship between support transitions and software retirement.

Potential conditions include:

## Support Active — Software Operational

## Support Limited — Software Operational

## Support Ended — Software Operational

## Support Ended — Migration Active

## Support Ended — Withdrawal Pending

## Support Ended — Software Withdrawn

## Support Obligations Continuing — Software Retired

These conditions must remain independently identifiable.

## Support and Migration Relationship

Support conditions may materially affect migration.

Relevant elements include:

## Migration Assistance Availability

## Compatibility Guidance

## Data Export Support

## Technical Expertise

## Migration Tool Availability

## Security Update Coverage

## Recovery Assistance

## Provider Cooperation

The end of support may reduce migration feasibility without eliminating the need for migration.

## Support and Dependency Relationship

Support changes may affect software dependencies.

Relevant elements include:

## Unsupported Libraries

## Unsupported Runtime Platforms

## Unsupported Operating Systems

## Unmaintained Interfaces

## Legacy Service Dependencies

## Unsupported Firmware

## Unmaintained AI Components

## External Support Dependencies

Dependency consequences must remain visible to applicable dependency and retirement governance mechanisms.

## Support and Operational Reality

ESMM must distinguish declared support status from actual operational conditions.

A software product may be officially unsupported but remain operationally critical.

A product may be listed as supported while essential correction capabilities are unavailable.

A vendor may announce extended support that applies only to specific versions or configurations.

An internally maintained component may remain technically serviceable without a formal external support contract.

Support governance must therefore evaluate the actual support relationship and available capabilities.

Declared Support Status ≠ Verified Support Capability.

## Governance Requirements

A conforming ESMM implementation must satisfy the following requirements. Support Identity and Scope

- Establish a stable support transition case identity
- Identify the applicable software object
- Identify the relevant software version or configuration
- Identify the support provider
- Identify the applicable support arrangement
- Define support scope
- Classify available support capabilities
- Preserve support evidence

## Support Transition

- Identify support transition origin
- Establish the applicable transition condition
- Distinguish announced and effective support changes
- Identify end-of-maintenance conditions
- Identify end-of-support conditions
- Identify security update availability
- Identify continuing support capabilities
- Preserve transition timing and scope

## Operational Consequences

- Identify continuing operational use
- Identify affected dependencies
- Identify affected users and systems
- Identify material support-related risks
- Identify required operational restrictions
- Preserve migration and retirement implications
- Identify continuing support obligations
- Preserve relevant uncertainty

## Responsibility and Communication

- Identify responsible support functions
- Identify applicable support authority

• Establish stakeholder communication requirements

• Preserve material support notices

• Identify responsibility transfer conditions

• Evaluate alternative support capability where applicable

• Preserve applicable exceptions

• Maintain support status traceability

## Verification and Continuity

• Verify material support status conclusions

• Preserve support capability distinctions

• Establish reassessment triggers

• Preserve support status changes

• Identify support transition closure conditions

• Preserve residual support obligations

• Prevent support termination from being treated as operational

• Maintain continuity with retirement planning, migration, dependency

withdrawal. management, and closure.

## Governance Logic

## Software Identity → Support Provider → Support Arrangement → Support Scope

→ Support Capabilities → Current Support Condition → Support Transition Origin → Transition Assessment → Effective Condition → Operational Consequences → Dependency Assessment → Security and Maintenance Implications → Continuing Responsibilities → Communication → Transition Verification → Resulting Support Status → Residual Obligations → Software End-of-Support Profile

Where support remains active:

## Support Capability → Scope Verification → Operational Applicability →

Continued Support Classification

Where support is reduced:

## Support Change → Capability Difference → Impact Assessment → Restrictions

/ Alternative Support → Updated Status

Where support ends but software remains operational:

## End of Support → Continued Operational Use → Dependency and Security

Assessment → Responsible Function → Restrictions → Migration or Retirement Pathway

Where support transfers:

## Previous Provider → Successor Provider → Capability Assessment →

Responsibility Transfer → Continuity Verification

Where evidence is insufficient:

## Support Claim → Evidence Gap → Unverified Classification → Further

Assessment

Where support conditions change:

## Existing Support Status → New Evidence → Reassessment → Updated Support

Profile

ESMM must not equate support termination with software retirement.

## Governance Outputs

The principal output is:

## Software End-of-Support Profile

Supporting outputs may include:

## Support Transition Case Identity

## Supported Software Identity Record

## Support Provider Profile

## Support Arrangement Record

## Support Capability Matrix

## Support Scope Record

## Support Lifecycle Status

## End-of-Support Condition Record

## End-of-Maintenance Condition Record

## Security Update Availability Profile

## Support Transition Impact Assessment

## Unsupported Software Operation Register

## Support Risk Record

## Operational Restriction Record

## Extended Support Profile

## Alternative Support Assessment

## Support Responsibility Transfer Record

## Support Communication Register

## Support Status Evidence Register

## Support Exception Register

## Continuing Support Obligation Record

## Support Transition Closure Record

## Minimum Implementation Framework

A minimum ESMM implementation must establish eight governance layers. Layer 1 — Software and Support Identity

## Identify the software object, applicable version, support provider, and

support arrangement. Layer 2 — Support Capability Definition

Establish which support and maintenance capabilities are available, restricted, or unavailable. Layer 3 — Support Transition Recognition

## Identify the origin, effective condition, scope, and timing of material

support changes. Layer 4 — Operational Consequence Assessment

## Identify continuing software use, dependencies, affected stakeholders,

security exposure, and operational restrictions. Layer 5 — Responsibility and Authority

## Establish support responsibility, applicable authority, provider transfer

conditions, and continuing obligations. Layer 6 — Transition Communication

## Preserve material notices, affected recipients, required actions, and

communication evidence. Layer 7 — Support Status Verification

## Verify the resulting support condition and preserve uncertainty,

exceptions, and reassessment requirements. Layer 8 — Support Continuity and Handoff

## Maintain the Software End-of-Support Profile and transfer relevant

requirements into migration, dependency management, and retirement closure governance.

The framework may be implemented through software inventories, service management systems, vendor lifecycle records, contractual registers, automated monitoring, or AI-assisted assessment.

Implementation technology must adapt to the governed support reality.

## Cross-Module Boundary

## RPM → ESMM

## RPM identifies support and maintenance conditions relevant to retirement

planning.

## ESMM governs the detailed recognition, assessment, transition, and

continuing consequences of those support conditions.

## ESMM → SMM

## ESMM identifies support capabilities, limitations, and transition

conditions affecting migration.

## SMM governs the actual migration of software functions, data, users, and

operational dependencies.

## ESMM → RDMM

## ESMM identifies unsupported software relationships and dependencies

affected by support termination.

RDMM governs residual dependencies that remain associated with software retirement.

## ESMM → RCCLM

## ESMM establishes the resulting support status and continuing support

obligations.

## RCCLM evaluates whether these obligations have been appropriately addressed

within the retirement closure determination.

End-of-support governance establishes the support condition. It does not establish that the software has ceased operating or that retirement is complete.

## Cross-Architecture Boundary

ESMM governs support and maintenance transitions within SRTS.

It may interact with other SLGA™ Parent Standards.

## SRS — Software Requirements Standard

## Requirements for continuing software capabilities, support-related

functionality, and replacement systems.

## SCS — Software Creation Standard

Creation of corrective, replacement, or migration software.

## SDS — Software Dependency Standard

Support-related dependency identity, continuity, and risk.

## SCFS — Software Configuration Standard

Supported configurations, version identity, and configuration changes.

## SQS — Software Quality Standard

Quality requirements and verification of maintained or replacement software.

## SSS — Software Security Standard

Security exposure, vulnerability management, and remediation.

## SRLS — Software Release Standard

Release governance for updates and replacement software.

## SDPS — Software Deployment Standard

Deployment and operational transition of updates or replacement systems.

## SCMS — Software Change Management Standard

Governance of software changes resulting from support transitions.

## SLCS — Software Lifecycle Control Standard

Lifecycle state consistency, transition control, exceptions, and continuity.

ESMM may also interact with applicable OOF® authority, accountability, operational reality, identity, and autonomous systems governance mechanisms.

It does not replace their specialized governance functions.

## Practical Applications

## Enterprise Software Support Lifecycle

## Managing support expiration, extended support, and continued operation of

legacy applications.

## Cloud Service Discontinuation

Governing support transitions and operational consequences when cloud providers discontinue products or service capabilities.

## Open-Source Software

## Identifying the actual maintenance and security support available for

community-maintained components.

## Software Supply Chains

Managing dependencies on libraries, runtimes, and platforms that no longer receive maintenance or security updates.

## AI Systems

## Governing support transitions for AI models, inference services,

orchestration software, and dependent applications.

## Autonomous Software Agents

Identifying continuing operational responsibilities when agent software or its underlying components lose support.

## Industrial and Embedded Systems

Managing firmware and software that remain operational within equipment after vendor support ends.

## Critical Infrastructure

## Preserving visibility into unsupported software, operational restrictions,

and required replacement or retirement pathways.

## Practical Use Case 1 — Unsupported Industrial Software

An industrial facility operates equipment controlled by software that is no longer supported by its original vendor.

The equipment continues performing an essential production function.

## A software inventory lists the product as obsolete, but the organization

has not established whether security updates, technical assistance, or corrective maintenance remain available.

ESMM establishes:

## Software Identity → Support Provider → Support Scope → Support

Capabilities → End-of-Support Condition → Operational Dependencies → Continuing Responsibilities

The assessment identifies:

• Ordinary vendor maintenance has ended

• Security updates are no longer provided for the installed version

• The equipment remains operationally necessary

• Immediate software replacement is not technically feasible

• A third-party provider can supply limited diagnostic assistance but

• Continued operation requires explicit restrictions and a governed

cannot provide comprehensive security corrections. replacement pathway.

The resulting support classification is:

## Unsupported — Restricted Operation; Alternative Diagnostic Support

Available.

## The Software End-of-Support Profile preserves the actual support

capabilities, operational restrictions, responsible function, and continuing retirement requirements.

Alternative Technical Assistance ≠ Full Software Support.

## Practical Use Case 2 — AI Service Support Termination

## An organization relies on an external AI inference service integrated into

several internal applications.

The service provider announces that support for the current model version will end.

A successor model is available, but it uses a modified interface and produces different output characteristics.

ESMM establishes:

## Model Service Identity → Supported Version → Provider Notice → Support End

Condition → Affected Consumers → Security and Maintenance Implications → Migration Requirements

The assessment identifies:

• The support announcement applies only to the older model version

• Existing applications continue calling the old endpoint

• Technical assistance will remain available temporarily, but

• Several applications require compatibility assessment before migration

• The provider's announced support termination does not establish that

model-specific corrections will stop. all dependent applications have transitioned.

The resulting support classification is:

## Support Transition Pending — Migration and Compatibility Requirements

Outstanding.

## ESMM preserves the transition conditions and directs the applicable

migration and dependency requirements to subsequent governance.

Successor Model Available ≠ Existing Integration Ready for Retirement.

## Critical Distinctions

Support Announcement ≠ Effective Support Termination.

Support Available ≠ Support Sufficient.

Support Provider Identified ≠ Support Capability Verified.

Support Contract Active ≠ Every Software Version Supported.

Vendor Support Ended ≠ All Support Capability Eliminated.

Support Capability ≠ Maintenance Capability.

End of Maintenance ≠ End of Support.

Security-Only Support ≠ Full Maintenance.

Extended Support ≠ Standard Support.

Alternative Support ≠ Equivalent Support.

Community Maintenance ≠ Contractual Support.

Support Terminated ≠ Software Withdrawn.

Unsupported Software ≠ Inactive Software.

Support Status Declared ≠ Support Status Verified.

Support Notice Delivered ≠ Operational Transition Completed.

Support Responsibility Assigned ≠ Support Capability Established.

Support Transfer Recorded ≠ Support Continuity Verified.

Support Transition Closed ≠ Retirement Closed.

Support Termination ≠ Elimination of Operational Responsibility.

## Canonical Boundary

## End-of-Support Management Module (ESMM) governs the identification,

classification, transition, verification, and continuing consequences of software support and maintenance conditions throughout the retirement lifecycle.

## It establishes the governance relationship between identifiable software

objects, support providers, available capabilities, effective support conditions, affected operational dependencies, and continuing responsibilities.

ESMM does not determine that software is retired merely because support has ended.

It does not independently execute software migration, resolve residual dependencies, withdraw software from operation, or establish retirement closure.

It does not replace contractual interpretation, legal determination, security remediation, or specialized lifecycle governance.

Its principal governance output is the:

## Software End-of-Support Profile

## This output establishes the evidence-supported support condition of the

software and the obligations that remain relevant to its continued operation, migration, or retirement.

## Canonical Closing Statement

The end of software support is not the end of the software's consequences.

An unsupported application may continue processing essential information.

A discontinued library may remain embedded within active systems.

An industrial controller may depend on firmware that no longer receives security updates.

An AI service may remain integrated into operational applications after its provider announces the end of support.

And an organization may continue relying on software whose available maintenance capabilities are substantially narrower than its declared support status suggests.

## ESMM establishes the governance structure required to make these conditions

explicit.

## It identifies the actual support capabilities available for each software

object and applicable configuration.

It distinguishes maintenance termination from broader support termination.

It preserves the consequences of continued unsupported operation.

## It governs transitions between support providers, extended support

arrangements, and restricted operational conditions.

## It connects support changes to migration, dependency management, and

retirement requirements.

And it ensures that the disappearance of a support service does not erase the operational responsibilities associated with software that remains in use.

Support governance must follow the capabilities that actually exist, the software that actually operates, and the obligations that actually remain.

## End-of-Support Management Module (ESMM) transforms support termination

from an administrative lifecycle announcement into a verifiable governance condition that preserves operational awareness, responsibility continuity, and the basis for controlled software retirement.